

The Solar System

The Sun and its family are called the Solar System. As well as the planets, there are more than 170 moons, millions of small rocks called asteroids, and billions of comets in the family. The Sun is in the center of the Solar System—everything else travels around it.

Going around the Sun

Each planet follows its own path, called an orbit, around the Sun. All the planets travel in the same direction, but at different speeds from each other.

A planet's year is the time it takes to orbit the Sun once. Neptune's year is very long—it lasts for about 165 Earth years.

